

Creo Advisors — Sample Marketing Collateral

“AI value is a map, not a multiplier” — positioning, messaging, and ready-to-use copy

Draft sample assets prepared by the ENT 105 team for Creo Advisors

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What this is. A sample set of ready-to-use marketing assets that *execute* the AI value-creation plan — so the strategy is concrete, on-brand, and immediately usable. Every piece follows the one rule: **rigor over hype**. Nothing here oversells AI; the credibility *is* the restraint. All claims rest on the public record; ratios are illustrative orders of magnitude, and self-reported market figures are attributed, not asserted.

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1 Positioning statement

The formal positioning (Geoffrey Moore format) — the single source of truth every other asset flows from:

For private-equity sponsors and operating partners underwriting AI-driven value creation — **who** cannot reliably separate durable AI value from hype, and so risk overpaying for deals or breaking the businesses they buy — **Creo Advisors is** the independent, buyer-side advisor **that** maps, function by function, what AI can actually automate and who it can amplify, so you underwrite the real number and capture value that lasts. **Unlike** the strategy firms, Big Four, and operating-partner shops whose AI “diligence” is a gateway to the AI build they sell — or the in-house platforms that build their own — **Creo sells no AI systems and no build**. That’s the point: the only firm whose read on *what to automate* has nothing to sell on the other side. We tell you what AI *can’t* durably do, not just what it can.

Category line. Independent, buyer-side AI due diligence for private equity — we read the deal; we don’t build the AI.

Internal short form. *Creo: the independent, buyer-side authority on what AI can actually do in a deal — the only one with nothing to sell on the other side.*

2 Messaging house

One core message on the roof; three pillars holding it up; proof under each.

Core message. *AI value is a map, not a multiplier — and we draw it.*

Pillar	Claim	Proof / reason to believe
Independent	We’re buyer-side and sell no AI systems <i>and no build</i> — our read isn’t conflicted.	Every external AI-diligence provider (strategy firms, Big Four, ops shops) funnels diligence into a build they monetize; Creo has nothing to sell on the other side — neutrality is the scarce asset in a hype market.
Rigorous & transparent	Every call is shown, not asserted — you can check it.	Grounded in established occupational-exposure research (Frey–Osborne; the OpenAI “exposure $\neq$ automation” study); reconciles to the number.
Amplify, don’t gut	Durable value is a swap, not a purge.	Deploy-and-fire is why most AI programs show no return (~95% of pilots fail; Klarna re-hired humans); we map who to amplify.

Message by buyer (lead with the line that fits the seat):

- **Deal partner (pre-deal):** “Price on the real ratio, not the pitch — before you overpay.”
- **Operating partner (returns to LPs):** “Most AI programs show no return. We map where the durable value actually is.”
- **Portfolio CEO (operator):** “Amplify your best people and collapse the busywork — without gutting what works.”
- **LP / IR (amplifier):** “Back your AI story with diligence you can defend.”

3 Taglines, boilerplate & elevator pitch

Tagline options (lead candidate first):

- *AI value is a map, not a multiplier.*
- *We tell you what AI can't do.*
- *The only AI read with nothing to sell.*
- *Price the real number.*
- *Rigor over hype. Buyer-side, always.*
- *Amplify the business — don't gut it.*

One-liner (for bios, intros, signatures)

Creo Advisors is the independent, buyer-side advisor that tells private-equity sponsors what AI can — and can't — durably do in a deal.

30-second elevator pitch

Every PE firm is chasing the AI roll-up, but most can't tell real AI value from hype — and the data shows it: about 95% of enterprise AI pilots fail, and only roughly 5% of companies capture real value. Creo is the independent, buyer-side advisor that maps, function by function, what AI can actually automate and who it can amplify — so sponsors price the real number instead of the pitch, and build value that lasts instead of gutting the business. We're the one voice that tells you what AI *can't* do.

Boilerplate (standard — press, LinkedIn “About,” deck back page)

Creo Advisors is a Boston-based boutique advisory firm specializing in independent AI value creation for private equity. Creo helps sponsors and their portfolio companies separate durable AI value from hype — mapping, function by function, what can actually be automated and who can be amplified — so buyers underwrite the real number and capture value that lasts. Independent and buyer-side, Creo sells no AI systems and no build — so, unlike every other AI-diligence provider, it has nothing to sell on the other side of its own read: its only product is a rigorous, transparent read on what AI can do in a deal.

4 Product description — the AI-Automatability Diagnostic

The flagship offer, written as a sell sheet.

The AI-Automatability Diagnostic — *know what's real before you pay for it.*

A fast, independent assessment of how much *durable* value AI can actually create in a target — and whether the business can execute the change without breaking.

Who it's for. Deal partners underwriting an AI thesis; operating partners who must show AI returns; portfolio CEOs under pressure to “do AI.”

How it works — two maps.

1. **The function map.** Every function sorted into *Collapse* (pure coordination, near-total automation) / *Amplify* (knowledge work, a few times more effective) / *Level-up* (routine work, AI

raises the floor) / *Keep-human* (judgment, physical, relationship, regulated) — with the real handoff ratio for each.

2. **The reselection map.** Whether the business has operators worth amplifying, and management able to run the swap — re-select for AI-fluent talent — without breaking quality.

What you get.

- The function-by-function ratio map.
- A **reselection-readiness** score (amplifiable talent + management’s capacity to execute).
- The “real vs. hyped value” gap — translated into what the deal is actually worth.
- The amplify / collapse / keep priorities — and the functions (or deals) to walk away from.

The engagement ladder.

Free	Complimentary mini-Diagnostic on one target — the proof, and the lead magnet.
Productized	Fixed-fee full Diagnostic on a deal or portfolio company.
Engagement	The value-creation / amplification roadmap (Creo orchestrates; vendors build).
Recurring	The trusted AI read across the sponsor’s portfolio.

Why Creo. Independent (we don’t sell the build) · rigorous and transparent (grounded in established automation research; shown, not asserted) · focused on durable value (amplify, don’t gut). *And the loop closes:* post-deal, Creo measures independently whether the projected value was actually created.

5 The AI Reality Report — lead-magnet copy

Gated-asset landing copy

The AI Reality Report — what actually works, and what actually doesn’t.

Creo’s annual, evidence-based read on where AI is creating real value in private equity — the function ratios that hold up, the failure rates nobody quotes, and the deals that blow up. No hype, no vendor spin — the independent, buyer-side view.

[**Download the report** →] (*name + work email*)

6 Website hero copy

Homepage hero

AI value is a map, not a multiplier.

Creo is the independent, buyer-side advisor that tells PE sponsors what AI can — and can’t — durably do in a deal. Price the real number. Capture value that lasts.

[**Get a free AI-Automatability Diagnostic**] [*Read the AI Reality Report*]

Three value props (the band beneath the hero):

- **Independent.** We sell no AI systems — so our read isn’t conflicted.

- **Rigorous.** Grounded in real automation research, reconciled to the number, shown not asserted.
- **Durable.** We amplify the people who run the business — we don't gut it.

7 Sample LinkedIn posts (founder-led)

Contrarian, evidence-based, in a founder's voice — attention *and* credibility.

Post 1 — “Map, not multiplier”

Every deck I see prices AI at one number. “AI makes this 10x more productive” — one multiple, applied to the whole company.

That's not how it works. A business is a portfolio of functions, and AI hits each one completely differently:

- Pure coordination — dispatching, matching, routing — can nearly disappear. (Uber did this to an entire industry.)
- Knowledge work amplifies a few times over: a great analyst with AI does the work of several — but you still need the analyst.
- Judgment, relationships, regulated work, anything physical — barely moves.

Price the average and you either overpay for the hype or miss the rare function that actually collapses. The value — and the risk — live in the mix.

AI value is a map, not a multiplier. Most buyers are still pricing the multiplier.

Post 2 — “The rehire is the tell” (public-record only)

The headlines say AI is replacing workers. Watch what the companies actually do.

Microsoft cut more than 15,000 roles last year. It also made AI use “no longer optional,” tied it to performance reviews, and shielded its own AI teams from the hiring freeze. That's not “the machine took the jobs.” That's a workforce being re-sorted for who can amplify with AI.

Here's the tell that separates real automation from hype: the rehire fraction. When a company sheds thousands and then quietly rehires a sizable share, AI didn't replace those people — it raised the bar on who gets to stay. A big rehire fraction means amplification, not the 1000-to-1 the hype promises.

For anyone underwriting an AI roll-up, that's the whole question: are you buying replacement, or reselection?

Post 3 — “95% fail”

About 95% of corporate AI pilots fail to deliver. That's not my number — it's the research.

So why does the handful that succeed succeed? It's almost never the model. The winners did three unglamorous things:

1. Found the functions where AI actually compounds — and ignored the ones where it doesn't.
2. Amplified their best people instead of replacing their cheapest.
3. Measured the result honestly, and killed what didn't work.

The losers bought a platform, fired a department, and waited for margin that never came.

If you're paying an AI-roll-up multiple, you're betting you'll be in the 5%. The only way to know is to look — function by function — before you sign.

Post 4 — “The model just went private” (timely; public-record only)

This week a16z funded a private-sector DOGE. Ex-DOGE staffers launched a firm called **Special** with one line: buy a company, automate the overhead, keep the margin. Their first target? A Texas eldercare business with hundreds of nurses.

Hold that up against the record. DOGE says it saved \$160B. One nonpartisan analysis (the Partnership for Public Service) estimates its actions will *cost* about \$135B this year once you count paid leave, re-hiring, and lost productivity. The cut booked as savings — and came back as cost.

Now run that logic on nurses. Eldercare is judgment, physical, relationship, regulated work — the most *keep-human* function there is. The durable AI value in that business isn’t the care; it’s the back office: scheduling, intake, billing. Automate *those* and margin expands. Cut the nurses and you haven’t cut cost — you’ve cut capacity, and it returns as turnover, quality, and risk.

“Buy a company, automate the overhead” is the right instinct. *Which* overhead is the whole question — and it’s a map, not a multiplier. We’ll be watching this one.

8 Sample nurture email

Email — sent after an AI Reality Report download

Subject: The 5% — what separates the AI programs that actually work

Hi {First name},

Thanks for downloading the AI Reality Report. One finding tends to stop people: roughly 95% of enterprise AI pilots fail to deliver a return — and the 5% that work rarely have better technology. They have a better *map*.

That’s the idea behind our AI-Automatability Diagnostic: an independent, buyer-side read of where AI can actually create durable value in a specific business — function by function — and whether the team can execute it without breaking what works.

If you’re underwriting an AI thesis right now, we’ll run a **complimentary mini-Diagnostic** on one target. No build pitch — we don’t sell AI systems. Just an honest read on what’s real.

Worth a 20-minute call?

Rich Vitaro — Creo Advisors

[**Book a call**]

Draft sample collateral prepared by the ENT 105 team for Creo Advisors. Copy is illustrative and for management review; names, figures, and claims to be finalized with Creo. All assets are public-record-only and independent — the brand promise is rigor over hype, so the copy never claims more about AI than the evidence supports.